

Noggin2

A second-brain system for Obsidian + LLM assistant. No plugins. No cloud. Plain markdown.

Core Idea

Capture fast in daily notes. Process later into topic folders. An LLM assistant bridges the two using tags as the interface. You never decide where something goes. Just write. The system catches up.

Folder Layout

```
Vault/
_inbox.md          capture buffer
_meta/            protocol docs, assistant memory
_templates/       daily note template
_compiled/        auto-generated intake logs + todos
_digests/         weekly digests
_maps/           Maps of Content (hand-curated)
YYYY-MM-DD topic.md  daily notes
Music Knowledge/   topic folders...
```

Daily Notes

One per day. Today is bare YYYY-MM-DD.md. After the day rolls over, the assistant adds a 2-4 word topic suffix (2026-04-11 ripleys seiko.md). Topic = the single most memorable thing, not the most important. Daily notes are append-only. The assistant only adds footnotes.

Tags the Assistant Acts On

Tag	What happens
<code>#askclaude</code>	Assistant answers via footnote (or new topic note for complex answers)
<code>#link-me</code>	Assistant does a linking pass: finds related notes, adds bidirectional wikilinks
<code>#todo</code>	Compiled into <code>_compiled/todos.md</code> as checkboxes with stable IDs
<code>#inspo</code>	Section captured into <code>_compiled/inspiration.md</code> . Add domain tag for filtering
<code>#seed</code>	Your creative fragments. Compiled per-topic into <code>Topic/seeds.md</code>
<code>#dailymusic</code>	Line compiled into <code>_compiled/music.md</code> (pair with <code>#Music</code>)
<code>#dailyfilm</code>	Line compiled into <code>_compiled/film.md</code> (pair with <code>#Movie</code>)
<code>#dailyquote</code>	Line compiled into <code>_compiled/quotes.md</code> (pair with <code>#Quote</code>)
<code>#dailyart</code>	Line compiled into <code>_compiled/art.md</code> (pair with <code>#Art</code>)

Tags the Assistant Ignores

`#rabbithole` `#deepdive` `#followup` `#Brightidea` `#todo-done` plus all your domain tags (`#Music`, `#Art`, `#Design`, `#Hardware`, etc). Greppable bookmarks. Never processed.

Footnotes

The annotation layer. Keeps the main body pristine. Ctrl-click a marker to jump to its definition. Definitions live under `##` footnotes at bottom of note.

Prefix	Purpose	Example
<code>[^c-N]</code>	Assistant's reply to <code>#askclaude</code>	<code>[^c-1]</code>
<code>[^src-slug]</code>	Source / provenance citation	<code>[^src-wikipedia]</code>
<code>[^YYYY-MM-DD-slug]</code>	Future-you annotating past-you	<code>[^2026-04-12-wrong]</code>

[^dig-N]	Digression you pulled out of	[^dig-1]
[^def-word]	Glossary / etymology drop	[^def-qid]
[^note-slug]	General side note	[^note-fuzz-pedals]

Rule: never edit a past line to correct it. Add a dated footnote instead. The archaeology matters.

Workflows

Ask a Question

Drop #askclaude with your question. Assistant appends [^c-1] and puts the answer in the footnotes section. Complex answers get their own topic-folder note.

Drop Inspiration

Drop #inspo #Design (or any domain tag) at the top of a block. Section from tag to next - - - gets compiled into _compiled/inspiration.md.

Drop a Seed

Drop #seed #Literature before your own creative fragment. Compiled per-topic. Inspo = external. Seed = you.

Todo

Drop #todo inline. Shows up in _compiled/todos.md as a checkbox. Check to mark done. Add #todo-done to archive from list entirely.

Promote to Topic Folder

Ask the assistant explicitly. Never automatic. Daily note body stays untouched.

Quick Capture

Open _inbox.md. Type one line. Save. Assistant routes it next session. Hints: -> Music Knowledge, -> askclaude, -> defer.

Rules

1. Today's daily note is never renamed. Topic suffix added next day.
 2. Daily notes are never rewritten. Assistant edits = footnotes only.
 3. Promotion to topic folders is always user-requested, never automatic.
 4. Compiled files are caches. Regenerate from scratch. Never hand-edit (except todo checkboxes).
 5. Never edit a past line. Add a dated footnote instead.
 6. No community plugins. Obsidian core + Sync + local assistant only.
 7. Screenshots can be OCR'd and removed. Handwritten content stays unless told otherwise.
 8. Scheduled runs are grep-first: zero work = one grep and one log line.
-

Obsidian Setup

Core plugins only: Daily Notes (template: _templates/daily_template, format: YYYY-MM-DD), Templates, Outline, Graph, Backlinks. **Exclude from graph:** _meta/ _compiled/ _digests/ _templates/ _inbox.md